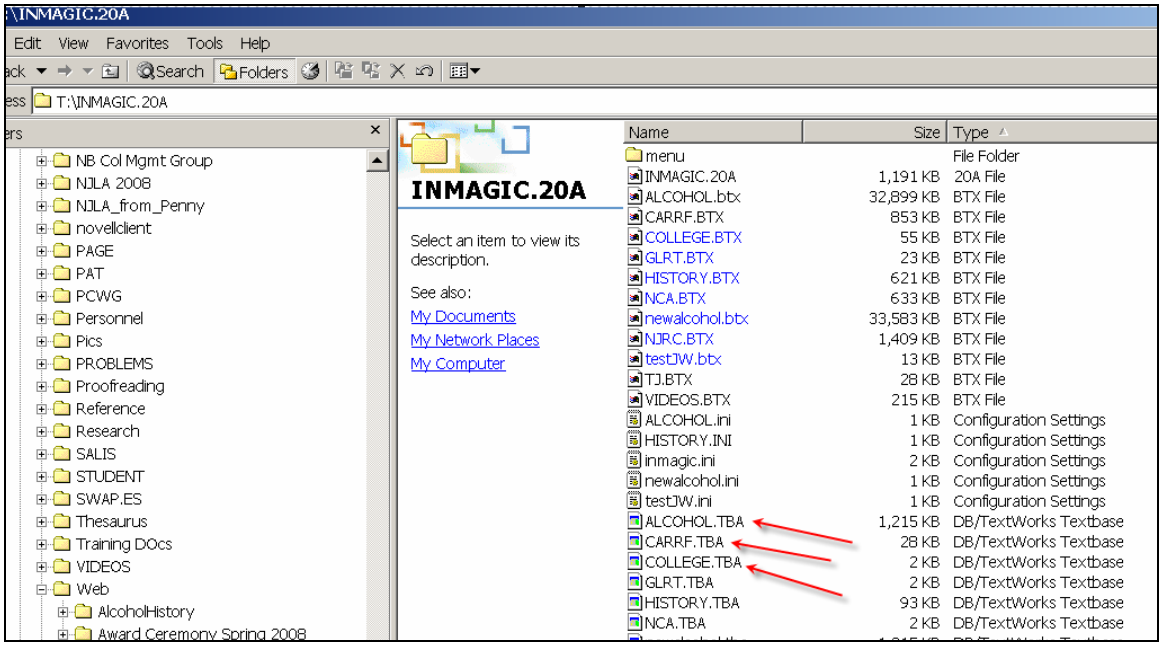
How to output records format from InMagic platform into Microsoft Access 2007 by using XML as intermediary.

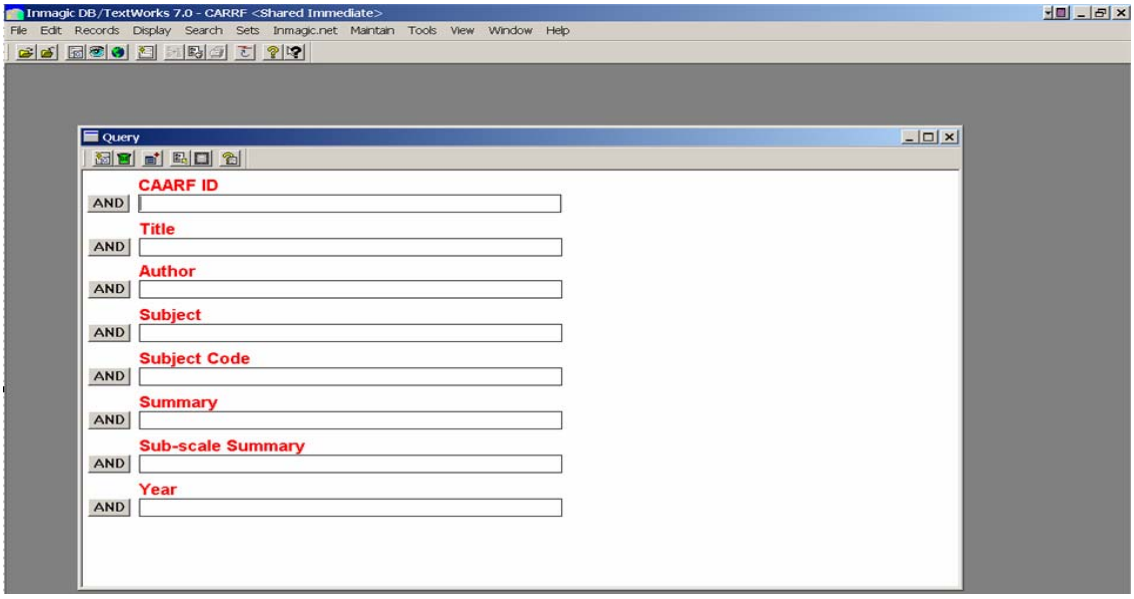
By Andy Tang

The alcohol studies library is still using INMAGIC 7.0 software to handle the hundreds of paper information. The library manager attempts to reach the target of representing these paper information in website. However, the old INMAGIC software do not support web based information management. Hence, the first problem is how to smoothly convert database from INMAGIC platform into Microsoft Access 2007 platform, simultaneously making a preparation for migration into MySQL platform in future. And finally, we plan to employ PHP+MySQL to build a web based information system.

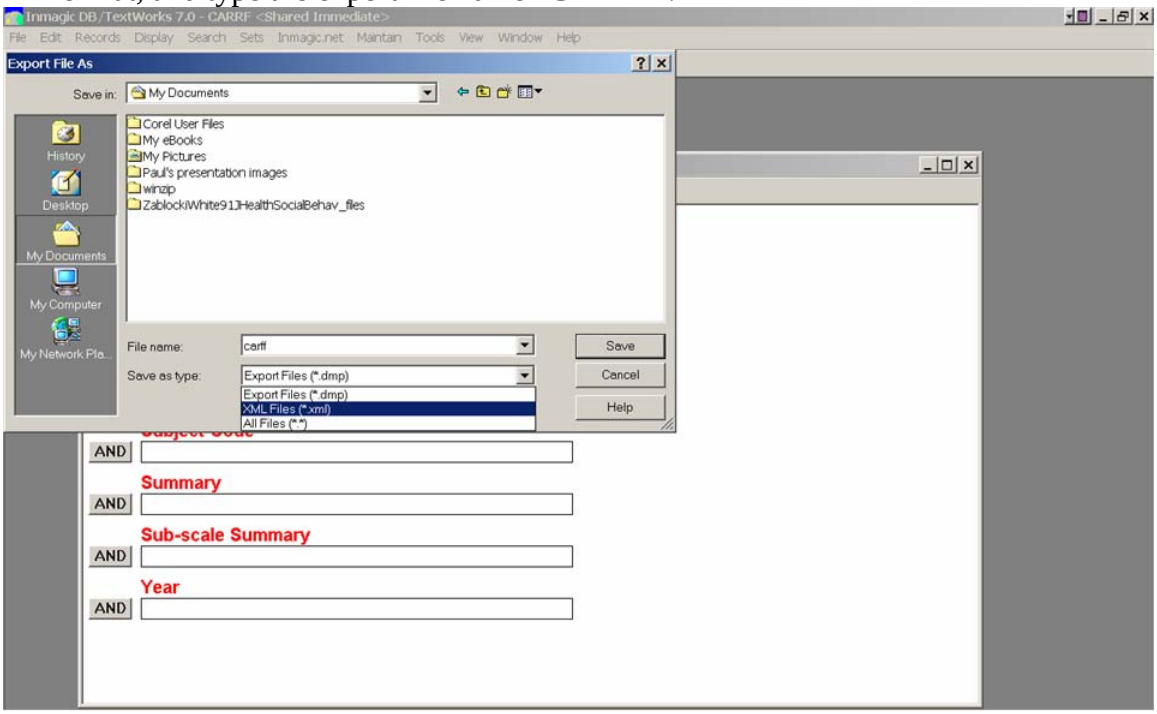
1. The first step is to locate the database files, which are hidden under the InMagic directory.



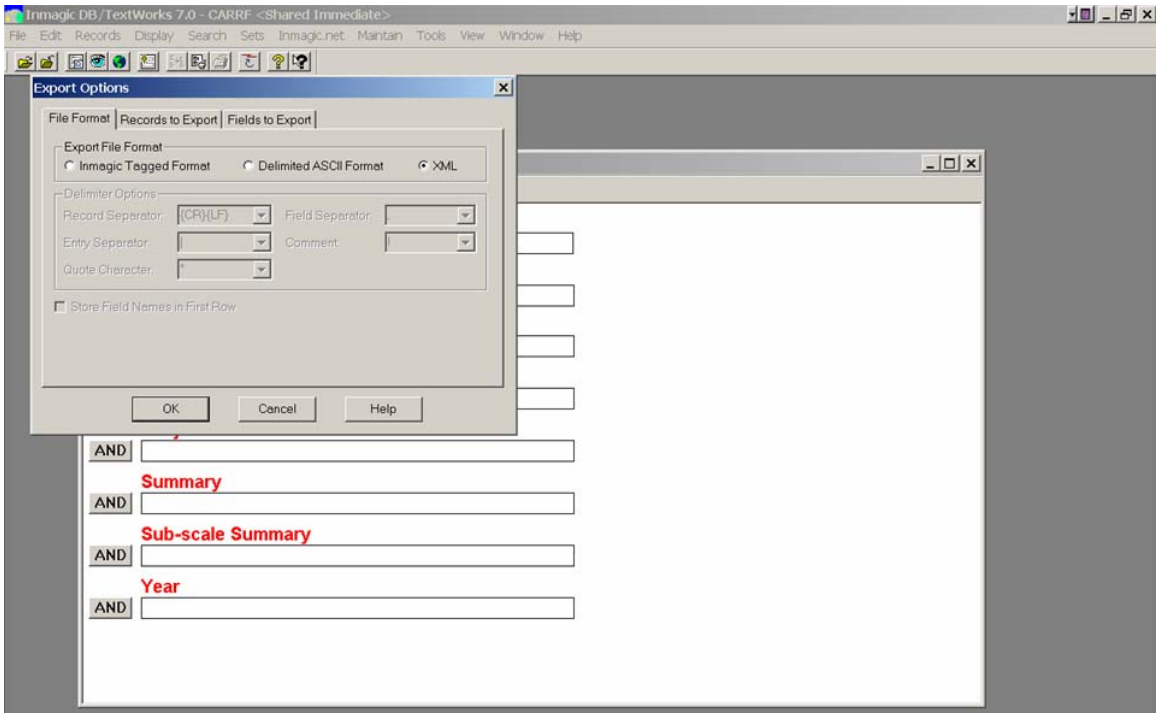
2. Double click the CARRF.TBA file which is the database file format of INMAGIC Textbase. The file CARRF.TBA is opened at the background, simultaneously a query window is ready.



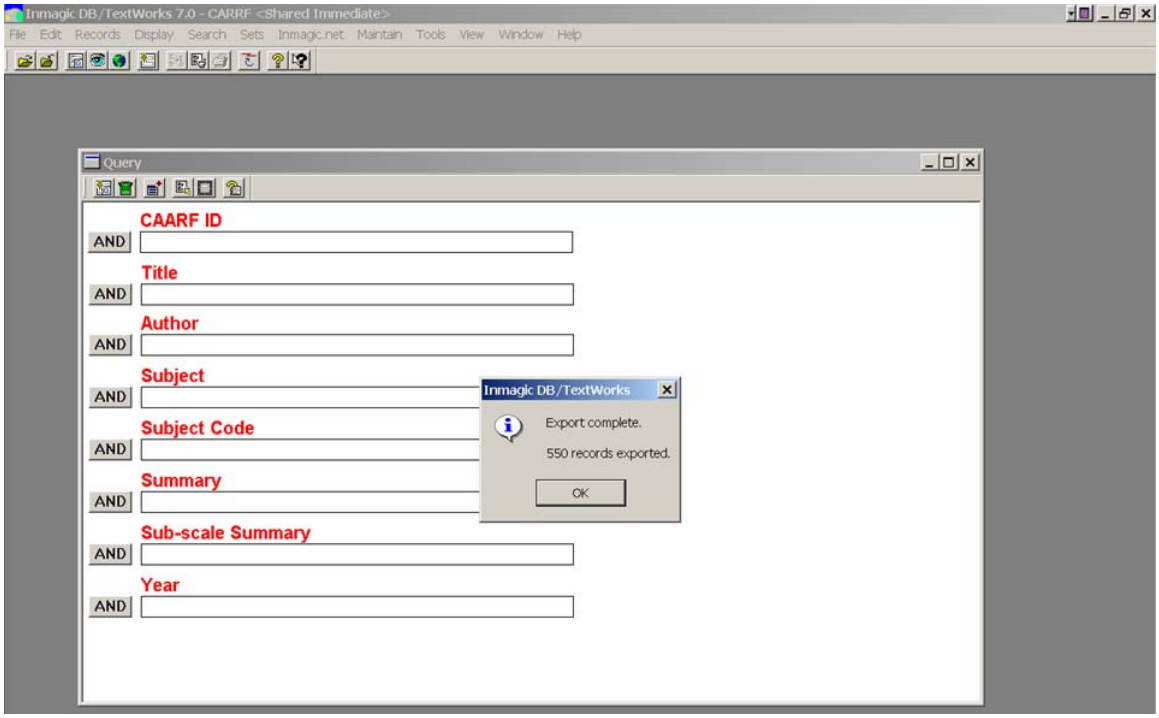
3. Click the file menu and choose “export file as” item, then choose the XML file format, and type the export file name “CARRF”.



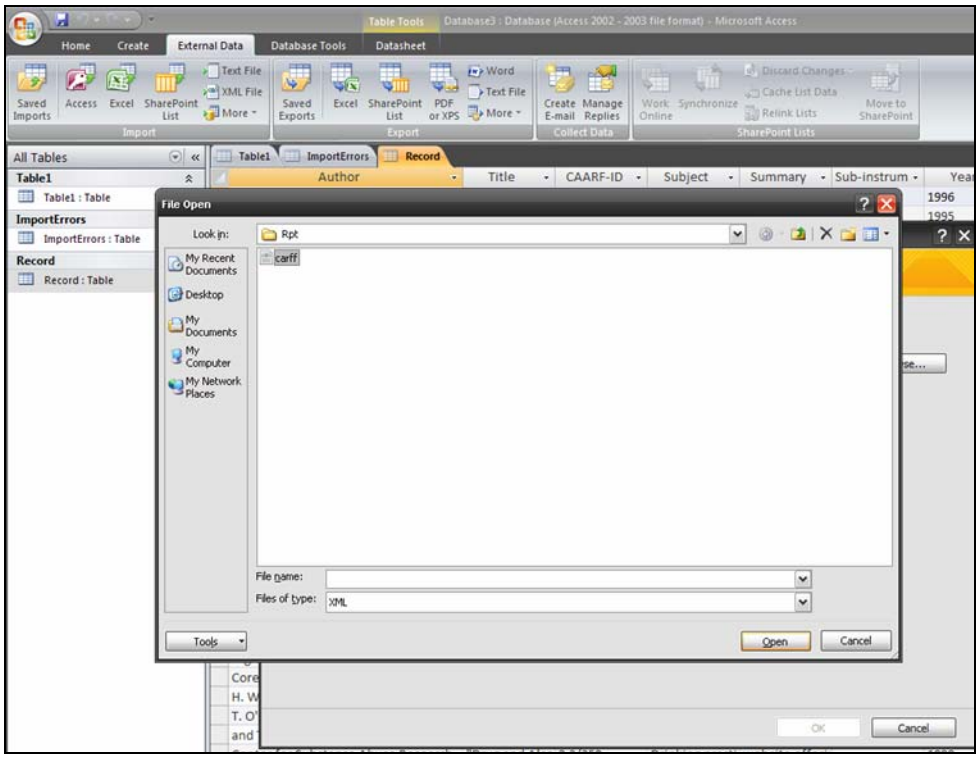
4. Then, choose the XML choice in the windows of “Export Options”, and click OK.



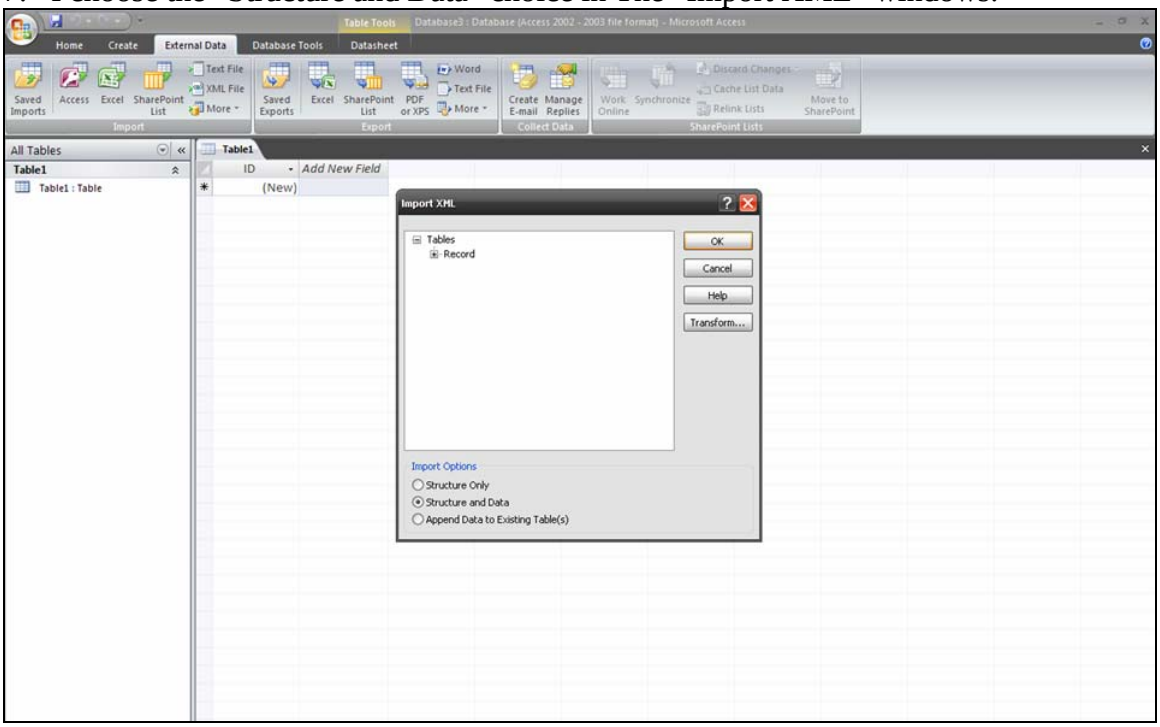
5. The records are converted to XML format file successfully, with 550 records exported. Next step is to consider how to put XML format data into Microsoft ACCESS software without loss.



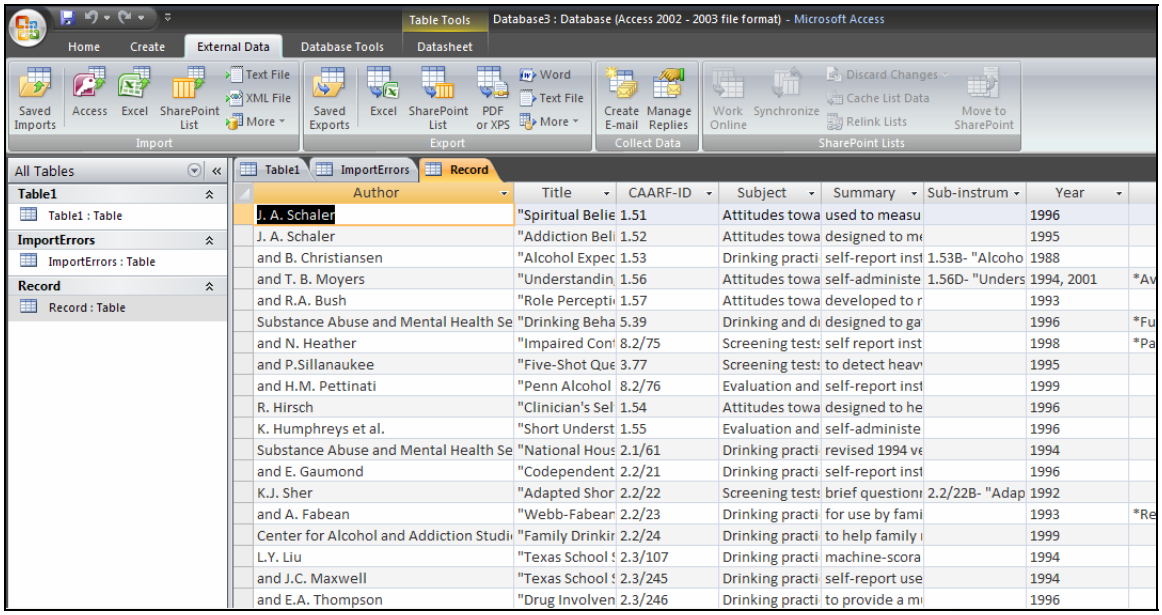
6. Use the Microsoft ACCESS 2007 to open the XML file, which is generated from INMAGIC in prior time, with the name of “CARRF.XML”.



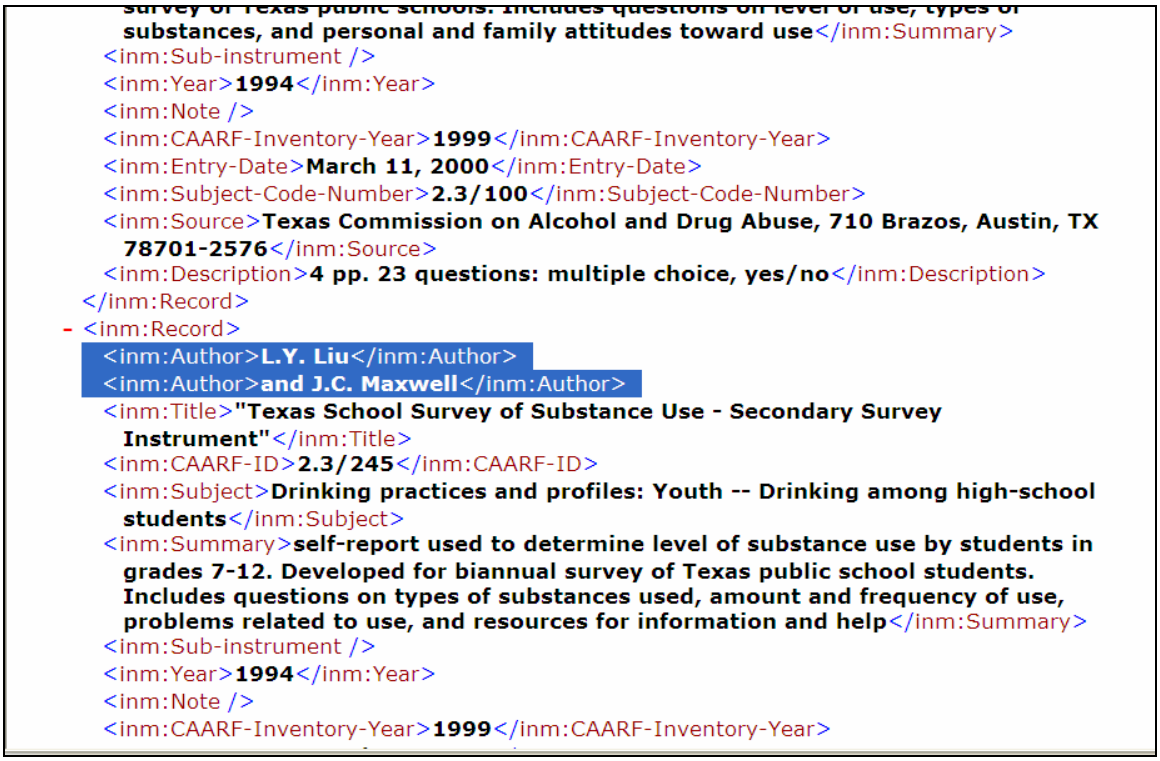
7. I choose the “Structure and Data” choice in The “Import XML” windows.



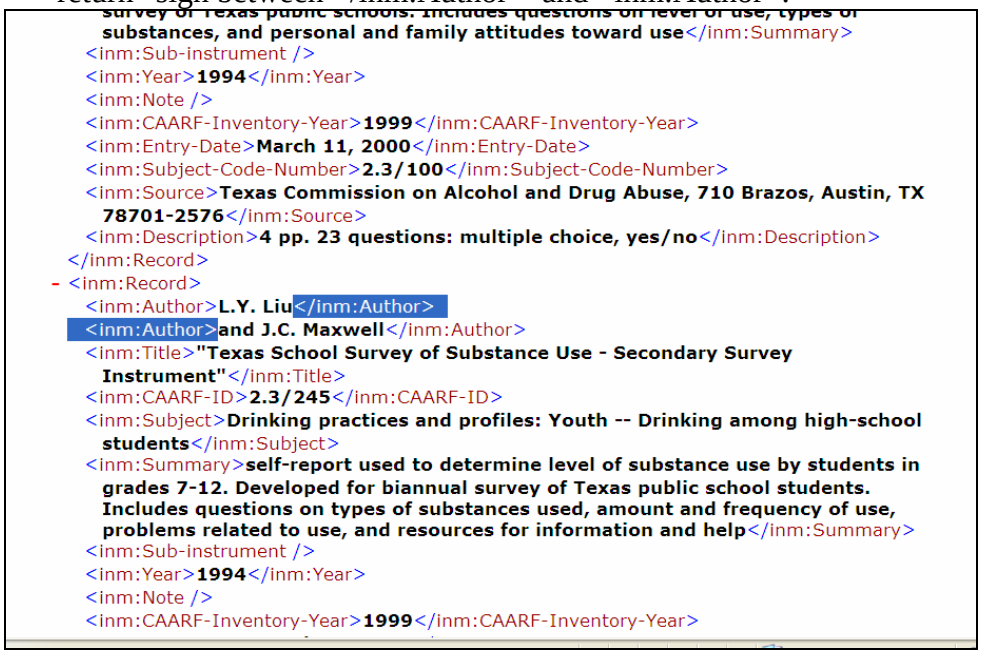
8. Then I get the converted results, displayed on the ACCESS 2007 windows. However, after I compare the converted results with the physical source records, I find some problems. The first one of them is that the second and the third author are lost, with merely the first author displayed in “Author” fields. The second one of them is that some contents in fields are cut by ACCESS 2006 for its only supporting the 255 character length in TEXT type field. This influences the content injection in the fields, such as “Subject”, “Sub-Instrument”, “Note”, and “Source” fields.



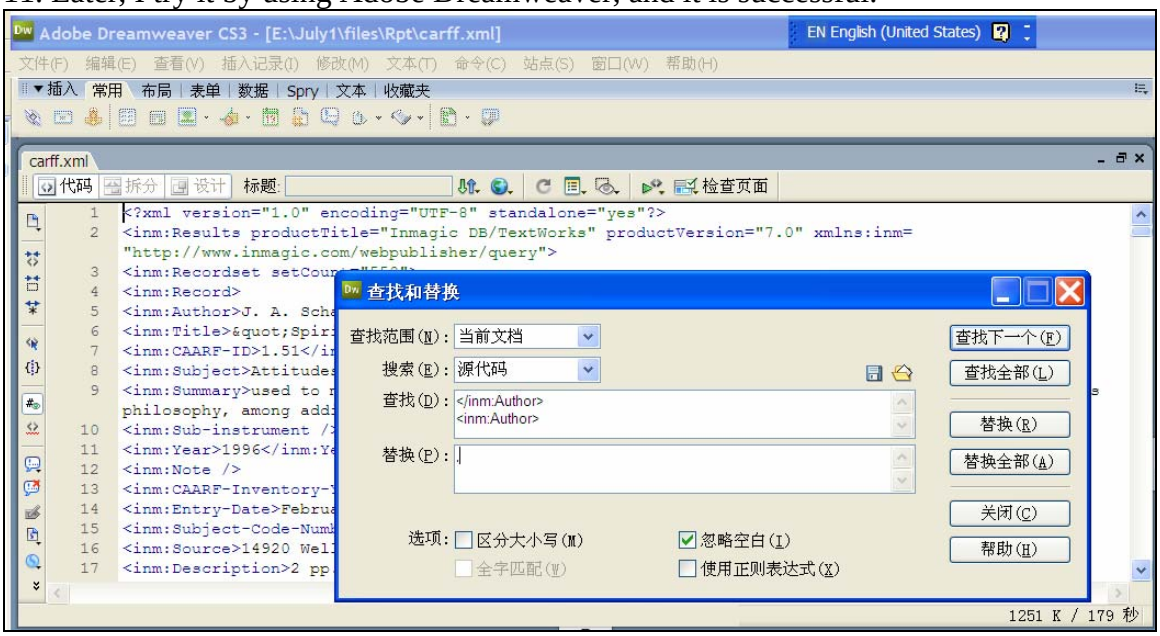
9. For the first problem, which loses other authors information, I decide to check the detail of XML file generated from INMAGIC system. I pay attention that, within one of records, there are two couple of <inm:Author> and </inm:Author> tag, which separately includes two authors names. Because of INMAGIC special working way, these two authors are not identified with different XML tags.



10. I find a characteristics that when a record have two or three authors, there will have a phenomenon that </inm:Author> and <inm:Author> close together, like demonstration on the shade part in illustration. If I use some software to search the character of "</inm:Author> <inm:Author>", and replace them with the comma, it will be perfect in combining more authors into one tags. I try to solve it using Microsoft Word, but it failed, because it can not conveniently handle the "return" sign between </inm:Author> and <inm:Author>.

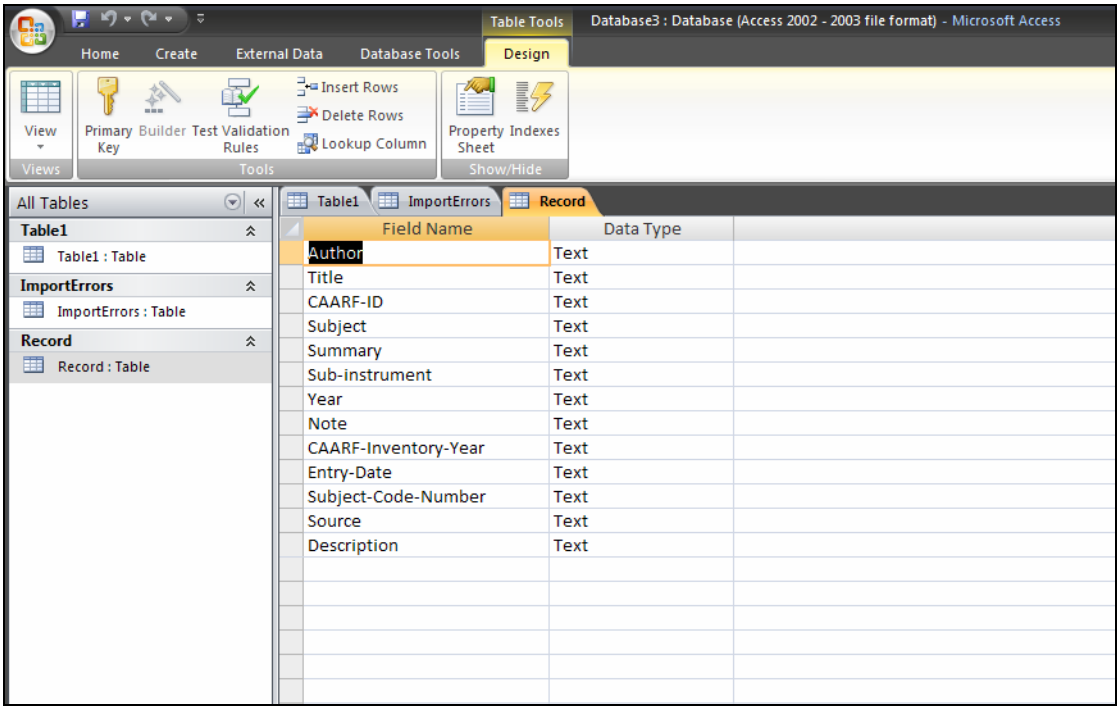


11. Later, I try it by using Adobe Dreamweaver, and it is successful.



12. I use Microsoft ACCESS 2007 to transfer the edited XML file again, and all the authors are coming out in the “Author” fields.

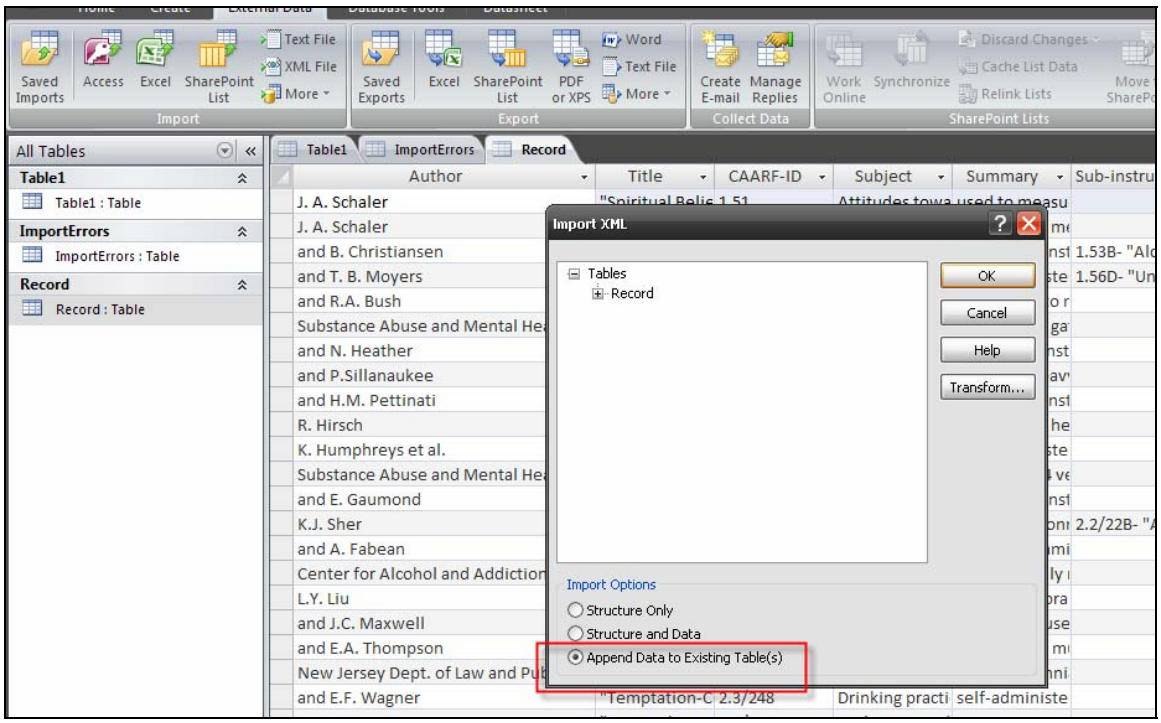
13. Now, it is the time to solve the second problem, which the source XML contents are curtailed and limited by the field length of 255 characters in ACCESS 2007. I check the database structure in Microsoft ACCESS 2007.



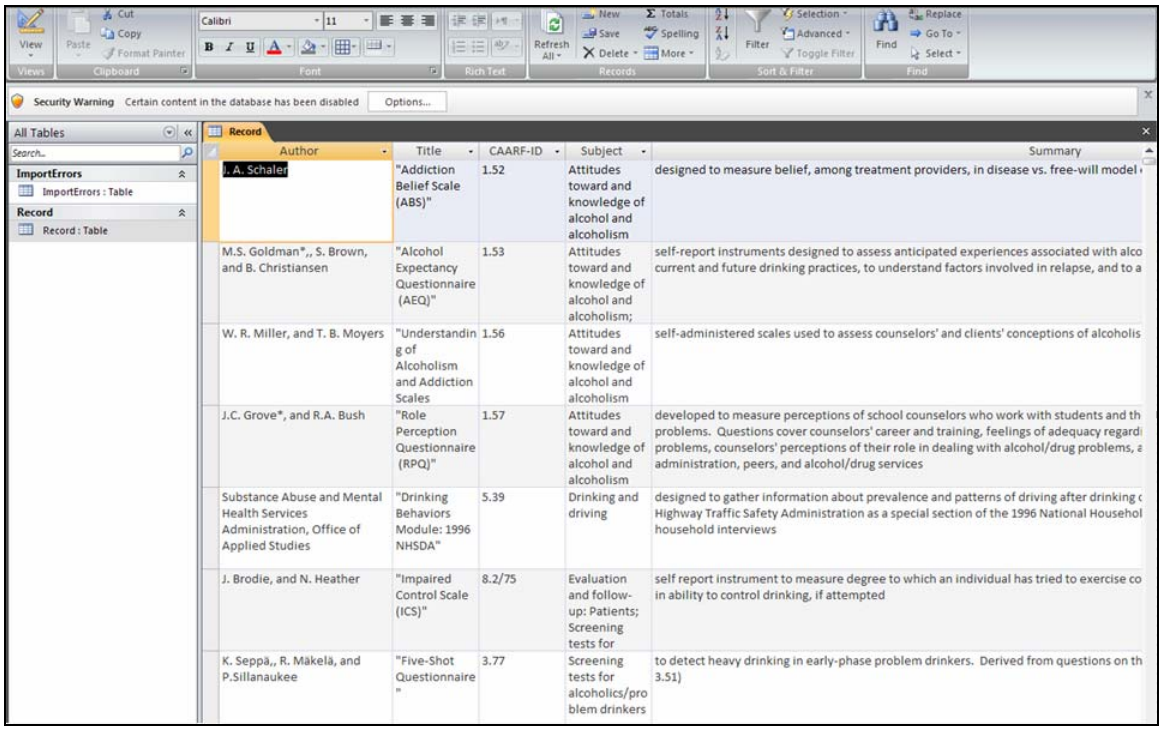
14. I decided to change some fields' data type from "Text" to "Memo". The data type of fields, such as "Subject", "Summary", "Note", and "Source", are changed into "Memo". In this way, the field size is enlarged and restriction is broken.

Field Name	Data Type
Author	Text
Title	Text
CAARF-ID	Text
Subject	Text
Summary	Memo
Sub-instrument	Memo
Year	Text
Note	Memo
CAARF-Inventory-Year	Text
Entry-Date	Text
Subject-Code-Number	Text
Source	Memo
Description	Text

15. Then, I clear the records in new database structure, and prepare to inject and append the contents into it again.



16. After going though entire steps, I get the final results with multi authors are inputted accurately, and the large-size contents are saved into the memo fields correctly without loss.



The future step will be to transfer these ACCESS 2007 table files into MySQL database, in case of supporting web based information management. Until now, the database conversion from INMAGIC platform into Microsoft Access 2007 is successfully completed.